

Bestworth Website And Admin Manual

This manual explains how to use, review, and test the public website and the secured admin system after deployment.

System Overview

- Public website for visitors, product discovery, leadership viewing, and inquiry submission.
- Admin portal for products, leadership, inquiries, CMS content, and account settings.
- Database-backed content and operational records.
- Email automation for inquiry notification, customer confirmation, and admin replies.

Public Website Features

- Hero section with controlled content and idle fade behavior.
- About section, values section, products, leadership section, and contact section.
- Leadership section includes paginated slides and biography modal behavior where biography text exists.
- Inquiry submission form saves to the database and triggers email workflows.

Admin Access

- Open the admin login page and sign in with the provided administrator credentials.
- If preview lock is active, password changes are temporarily disabled even though login still works.
- If the database is unavailable, the system redirects to a service-unavailable page instead of failing silently.

Admin Sections

1. Overview

- Shows total catalog items, new inquiries, and leadership count.
- Shows a quick system status summary.

2. Catalog

- Create, edit, feature, and delete products.
- Upload or paste product images.
- Manage product categories used on the public site.

3. Leadership

- Create, edit, and delete executive profiles.
- Set executive name, role, portrait, display order, and biography.
- Configure public leadership slider settings, including auto-slide and delay seconds.

4. Communications

- View all inquiries submitted from the public site.
- Mark inquiries as read, archive them, delete them, or send a reply.
- Use prebuilt email templates or save custom templates.

5. Site CMS

- Branding Assets: logo and favicon.
- Hero Content: heading, text, media, and idle fade settings.
- About Us Section: text and image.
- Contact Information: company contact details.
- Our Values: add, remove, reorder, and edit values.
- Footer and Socials: default links plus additional handle-based social items.

6. Settings

- Update admin username and company notification emails.
- Password updates are available only when password change is not locked.

How To Test The System

- Public test: open the website and confirm all sections load correctly.
- Product test: add or edit a product in admin and confirm the public products section updates.
- Leadership test: add or edit an executive and confirm the public leadership section updates.
- Inquiry test: submit a public inquiry and confirm it appears in the admin panel.
- Email test: confirm the company receives the new inquiry email and the user receives the confirmation email.

- Reply test: send an admin reply and confirm the reply is stored on the inquiry record.

Recommended Monthly Checks

- Confirm public pages load and images appear correctly.
- Confirm admin login still works.
- Send one test inquiry and verify email delivery.
- Review Render, MongoDB Atlas, and SendGrid billing and health.
- Review leadership slider behavior if leadership count grows.

Troubleshooting Basics

- If the site loads but data is missing, check MongoDB Atlas connection health.
- If inquiries save but no email arrives, check SendGrid activity and billing.
- If admin features stop responding, confirm the Render service is healthy and environment variables are present.
- If the system shows a service-unavailable page, check database availability first.

Important Environment And Service Notes

- PUBLIC_APP_URL sets the public application address used in links and media resolution.
- MONGODB_URI controls the production database connection.
- EMAIL_PROVIDER and SENDGRID_API_KEY control email delivery.
- ALLOW_ADMIN_PASSWORD_CHANGE can temporarily lock password updates during preview.

Operational Best Practice

Always test the public inquiry flow after any email, hosting, or database change. The website is more than a visual brochure - it is a live operational system with hosting, content, inquiries, and email dependencies working together.